



Speech Structures + Round Strategy

Looking Ahead

WACFL 1 Pre - Registration???

Tab Accounts ???



Introduction to Speech Writing Pt. 1

All speeches in Congress are **three** minutes long. You'll be given three time signals by the PO during your speech. The PO will gavel:

- once at **two minutes**
- twice at **two minutes thirty seconds remaining**
- three times at **two minutes & fifty five seconds/three minutes (depends on PO) minutes.**

The PO will start to slowly gavel you down at 3 minutes until 3 minutes 10 seconds at which point you will be inaudible. This is your cue to wrap up!

You can give a speech less than three minutes, but it is frowned upon. Three minutes is not hard to fill up.





Introduction to Speech Writing Pt. 2

Novices start off by writing entire speeches and reading them off. This approach is only acceptable for first one to two tournaments. Afterwards, to advance in your Congress career, a different style is needed. Speeches must be spoken extemporaneously, meaning they should be spoken based on an outline of notes rather than recited word-for-word.

You will be allowed to bring up any notes you wish to speak with. Speeches should not be memorized. Put your speeches/notes on top of a legal pad to appear more professional.

You should use effective word choice, correct sentence structure, and clear transitions to signpost ideas. Connect with the audience through sustained eye contact.

During a speech, never break character or use personal examples. What this means is that you must pretend to be a real Congressperson. You cannot say, “we are students” or “in my school” or anything like that. You should also not go overboard and say “When I studied at Harvard Law” or anything like that. You must never break the fourth wall. Stay focused on the debate.





Introduction to Speech Writing Pt. 3

Above all, make sure that your speech moves the debate forward. One thing judges and competitors dislike is **rehash** – when you bring up points that have already been brought up. To avoid rehash:

- Develop nuanced arguments & find unique warrants for stock arguments (*think back to mastering arguments*)
- Give a speech early so there's a minimal chance of rehash – more on round strategy later
- **Perform an extension.** – where you take that same point and deeper analyze the argument than the person who brought it up before you so you can still add new information to the debate. This can be done with refutations or sources that go into more depth than the person who took your points.
 - It's not rehash if you do it better than them!



Introduction to Speech Writing Pt. 4



- When called on by the PO, you walk to the front of the room and ask you walk up, you say the following words before the speech:
 - “I am Representative (last name) spelled _ _ _ _ from Rock Ridge High School. I will begin at your leisure. Just give me an indication whenever you are ready and I will begin.”

At that point, wait until you see the judges look up and either give you a smile, nod, thumbs up to indicate they are ready . The parliamentarian and PO are always ready but make sure the judges look up before starting.

The introduction is not counted as part of your three minutes



STAPLES

Clayton 80s any f size
 Predictable single, high school remote + minimum wage
 off - more magic - ignore major flaws that enable any don
 not a movie, not any gets happy ending

Roll back tape on debate → Davis + ↓ poverty BUT x jobs
 • Zhang → CSR study, millions jobs losses
 When business can't afford [THE ONES THAT CAN
 WILL NOT AUTOMATE LOW SKILLED JOBS]

Forbes 2017 found that 1 min wage ↓ automobile employment
 held by low skilled workers

Brookings 2014 - 88% of US jobs could be replaced by machines

A: Davis → gives employers push to PERMANENTLY replace
 constantly pushing workers into the streets + into poverty
 Davis + Hanson, SOME see rise in wage doesn't make it. f. millions
 have NO WAGE b/c companies not to ↓ labor costs or cut off

Even in off best case of off + no jobs are lost, FAIL

W: Negate b/c companies will change worker status of employees
 to independent contractors to keep them underpaid, slashing benefits in process

E: Rep. for professional employees gone w/6 → business short on funds,
 systematically convert employees to I.C.s TO AVOID MIN WAGE

E: IRS → millions of employees have ALREADY sacrificed b/c
 contracts are not protected by min wage + benefits

A: fore business to pay debt → sacrifice to cut labor costs

E: same 2016 report → FedEx cut its labor costs by 40% by modifying

I: ~~corporate~~ lose life saving benefits - underpaid -
 millions who rely on employee sponsored healthcare stand to lose it

Isn't a s.w. screen worth it, f.!

Padding your speeches

- Write as little as you can
 - Write in shorthand
 - Leave room to insert refutation/weighing/round integration
 - Optional - write analysis in round so you can adapt your argument and its explanation to what ppl are saying better
- Use different colors to your advantage
 - Associate colors with different parts of your speech to help with emoting
 - Use contrasting colors to better tell which part of your speech your on
- Do NOT read your intro off your pad
 - But u can have little notes jic u forget it and need to glance
- Pad your speeches right before or during round to help you remember

*Novices may print speeches, but speeches should still be on one page. Leave space for refutations and changes.

Standard Speech Structure

- Introduction (15 to 25 seconds)
 - Hook (Quotation, Analogy, Statistics)
 - Address the legislation and clearly stating your stance
- Body (Apx. 2:10 – 2:20 Minutes)
 - Claim: issue of debate; point or points that are in conflict.
 - Warrant: Reasoning to support the argument;
 - Evidence: Explain how the proof relates to the claim/warrant pair.
-NEEDS AT LEAST ONE SOURCE
 - Impact: why the argument is important/significant, especially to the particular side debated. Challenge the opposition to respond to an issue. **-NEEDS AT LEAST ONE SOURCE**
- Provide 2-3 meaningful arguments
- Wrap-up/Conclusion (about 10– 15 seconds)
 - State primary points
 - Summarize key arguments
 - Tie Rhetoric Back

Types of Speeches Pt. 1

Authorship/Sponsorship:

The first affirmative, or sponsorship, speech, which is delivered by the author of the bill or a sponsor, differs from other speeches.

Unlike regular speeches, a sponsorship must **completely introduce** the audience to the topic. Additionally, because it is the first speech on a piece of legislation, it is **entirely scripted** and needs to be completed before the session begins. A sponsorship speech has two goals: **to introduce and to advocate.**

What Do Sponsorships Do?



Describe the Problem

- Regardless of the format, sponsors should be able to articulate the problem the legislation is trying to solve
- If I don't care about your problem, I don't care about your bill!

Explain How the Bill Solves the Problem

- Refer to a section of the bill
- Give both the warrant and evidence for how the bills solved the problem

Pre-Refute (optional)

- The sponsorship is the only speech without speakers to refute- that may you anticipate a core neg argument and provide a refutation to it



Problem



Describe the Problem

- Give context
- Give evidence to explain the issue in the status quo

Warrant the problem

- This sets apart good sponsors from great sponsors
- Make sure the warrant plays into your solution

Impact the Problem

- Make me **care** about the problem



Solvency



Reference the bill

- “Section _ of this bill does _”

Warrant

- ____ leads to ____ which solved the problem because ____

Solvency Card

- Read evidence to prove your warrant



Sample Authorship

Sample

Injection Sites Author

- This was the perfect authorship. Solid intro, clear inherency, well-warranted empirics and impacts for solvency. One of only 2 speeches all day I would have given perfect speaker points if I was a scorer and not Parli.
- You stood well in questioning, but don't let Taboada bully you

Types of Speeches Pt. 2

Constructives:

Similar to any other speech in Congressional Debate, a constructive speech seeks to educate and persuade the audience about a given issue.

Constructive speeches set the foundation for the debate, helping to shape the direction of the discussion. Typically where the stock is laid out.

They are typically delivered at the beginning stages of a debate round, allowing debaters from both the affirmation and the negation to present their case.

Use the [SSSSteps](#) to adapt your speeches through the round into the middle of the speech cycle.

Sample Constructive Argument

C: This bill will lead to greater unemployment

W: A higher minimum wage requires small business owners to spend more capital, of which they already have limited

E: 30% of small businesses fail because they run out of capital. This number increases to 50% in a small business's 5th year of business Forbes 2018

L: Small business owners already struggle with a lack of capital. When you force small businesses who are already struggling with capital problems, and essentially double their expenses by doubling the minimum wage, they only have two options: cut their number of employees, or shut down entirely. Either case results in job loss, which is why

E: Raising the minimum wage would cause 1.4 million job loss by 2025 CNBC 2021

I: Congress always prided itself on looking out for the little guy. But if we pass, the affirmation's attempt to help lift workers out of low paying jobs will only result in them being placed even further in the trenches of poverty

Types of Speeches Pt. 3:

Fake Crystal - Mid to Late Round

1. Two most important questions in the round
2. Decide before round
3. Describe how your side wins on both questions
4. Refute other side
5. Fake version
 - a. Disguise your constructive
6. Intuitively flows from a 2 point standard constructive speech

Sample Structure

The two major questions in today's debate:

1. Does the FTC have the infrastructure to check all the reports?
2. Will consumers really gain protection through this bill?

Answer is no to both, so negate.

- a. **FTC doesn't have correct infrastructure.**
 - i. Warrant: FTC is understaffed, and has never conducted a task like this before.
 - ii. Evidence
 - iii. Impact: Reports will be wasted, because FTC can't determine credibility.
 - iv. Refute other side
- b. **Consumers will be hurt by this bill.**
 - i. Warrant: no feasible way for business to conduct this report
 - ii. Evidence
 - iii. Impact: Businesses will be fined, hurting consumers

Round Strategy

Round Strategy Step 0: Docket Analysis

Review the legislative docket upon its release, usually on Wednesday night or Thursday morning before the tournament.

Organize the legislation by topics, noting the number of bills on each topic and the schools that authored them – larger schools have more influence during committee time.

Topics with similar legislation are more likely to be discussed and placed higher on the agenda.

Identify topics that may have a heavier affirmation or negation bias to help you choose a side and prep.

Use this information to start your preparation strategically.

Round Strategy

Step 1: The First Session

In the first session, the first two topics on the agenda are typically discussed due to time constraints & their popularity.

Whether you speak early or later on the first topic on the agenda depends on the Presiding Officer's discretion, so be flexible and prepared to speak early or late.

If speaking on the second topic, you have more flexibility as you have precedence over those who spoke in the first session.

Note that in the second session, those who spoke on the first topic will have recency over you. You have to give or take.

Round Strategy

Step 2: The Second Session

From the second session onwards, it becomes a fair game for all competitors.

Depending on the tournament, the chamber will cover the next two to three topics on the agenda.

Your performance in these sessions is based on your level of preparation, so ensure thorough research and a solid speech structure.

Round Strategy Step 3: The Third Session

Session three is typically the slowest, as competitors are tired, and there are fewer remaining topics on the agenda. Typically, the topics left are those with 1 - 2 legislation on the docket.

Prior to the tournament, come prepared with research and a general speech structure for these topics.

After speaking in the second session and during lunch, jot down or print out any additional points or arguments you have for the remaining topics.

How is Speech Structure Relevant to Round Strategy ?

If you aim to speak early in the round, focus on writing a strong constructive speech. Captivate the judges' attention and set the stage for the debate.

If you have authored legislation in the debate round, prepare accordingly. You will know how likely you are to have a chance to sponsor a piece of legislation when the legislative packet is released.

If you are seeking to speak late in the round, focus on listening through the round, understanding both sides of the issue, and crafting a solid crystal.

Remember to always stay flexible and adaptable as things can vary between tournaments. Practice both early and late round strategies. Comfortability with various speaking styles helps impress the judges and show your competence.